

D567

Social Psychology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

At a grocery store with a new self-checkout lane, a shopper sees a man snap at a cashier and thinks, "What a rude person." She does not know the man just left a hospital where his father is in intensive care. The store is having a sale on apples. What error is the shopper most likely making?

- A. The fundamental attribution error.
- B. Confirmation bias caused by the crowded sale.
- C. The self-serving bias.
- D. A correct judgment, because rude behavior always reflects character.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

When people explain their own late arrival, they tend to cite traffic; when explaining someone else's, they tend to cite laziness. Which pattern is this, and which way does it lean for the self?

- A. The actor-observer bias: situational explanations for oneself, dispositional ones for others.
- B. Social loafing.
- C. The actor-observer bias: dispositional explanations for oneself, situational ones for others.
- D. Group polarization.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

In a study at a university with a large sports stadium, participants complete a boring task. Some are paid \$1 and others \$20 to tell the next participant it was fun. Afterward, all rate how enjoyable the task really was. The study ran in the fall semester. Which group is expected to rate the task as more enjoyable, and why?

- A. The \$20 group, because larger rewards produce more positive attitudes.
- B. Neither group, because attitudes never change after behavior.
- C. The \$1 group, because the small payment does not justify lying, so they reduce dissonance by liking the task more.
- D. Both groups equally, because both told the same lie.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company wants employees to sincerely value a new safety rule. Which approach does dissonance theory predict will produce the most genuine attitude change?

- A.** Threaten severe penalties for breaking the rule.
- B.** Post the rule and require no behavior at all.
- C.** Pay a large bonus for following the rule.
- D.** Ask employees to follow the rule with a mild request and no large reward or threat.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A new employee at a law firm with a marble lobby is unsure how to file a complex court form. She watches three coworkers file it a certain way and does the same, believing they know the correct method. The firm has 40 attorneys. What type of influence is this?

- A.** Informational influence.
- B.** Normative influence.
- C.** Obedience.
- D.** Peer pressure, since all conformity is about acceptance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

In a replication of a classic obedience study at a research center with a new parking garage, participants are told by an experimenter to deliver what they believe are painful shocks. The study was advertised in a local newspaper. Which change would most likely reduce obedience?

- A.** Screening out anyone with a cruel personality, since only cruel people obey.
- B.** Having the experimenter stand right beside the participant.
- C.** Having two other participants openly refuse to continue.
- D.** Running the study at a prestigious university.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A man collapses on a crowded subway platform during rush hour, next to a colorful mural. About 40 people see him fall, but for nearly two minutes no one calls for help. A street musician is playing nearby. What best explains the delay?

- A. The music made it impossible for anyone to notice.
- B. The large number of witnesses should have made help faster.
- C. Diffusion of responsibility: each person assumes someone else will act.
- D. People in cities never help strangers.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8.

A skilled pianist who teaches at a community music school plays a piece she has performed for years in front of a large audience and plays it better than in practice. The concert hall has red velvet seats. What best explains her improved performance?

- A. Social loafing.
- B. Social facilitation, because the task is well learned.
- C. Social facilitation, because the task is new to her.
- D. An audience always improves performance.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A class project is graded only as a group, and one member does very little. What change would most directly reduce this behavior?

- A. Make the group larger.
- B. Grade each member's identifiable contribution as well as the group product.
- C. Keep a single group grade but raise its point value.
- D. Have the group present to an audience.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10.

A tight-knit hospital leadership team that meets in a sunny conference room approves a costly expansion. Two members privately doubt the plan but stay quiet because the CEO is enthusiastic and they value team harmony. The expansion fails within a year. Which process best describes the decision?

- A.** Social loafing.
- B.** Normative influence, which is unrelated to group decisions.
- C.** Group polarization.
- D.** Groupthink.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A volunteer for a nonprofit that runs a community garden asks a neighbor to sign a petition supporting safer crosswalks. A week later she asks the same neighbor to put a large sign on his lawn. He agrees. The neighbor owns a golden retriever. Which technique was used?

- A.** Door-in-the-face.
- B.** Foot-in-the-door.
- C.** Low-balling.
- D.** Normative influence from the neighborhood.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A fundraiser wants a \$50 donation. Using door-in-the-face, what should she ask first?

- A.** A \$5 donation, then ask for \$50 later.
- B.** The \$50 donation directly.
- C.** A \$50 donation, then add a processing fee after agreement.
- D.** A \$500 donation, then retreat to \$50 after it is refused.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

At a grocery store ~~with a new self-checkout lane~~, a shopper sees a man snap at a cashier and thinks, "What a rude person." She does not know the man just left a hospital where his father is in intensive care. ~~The store is having a sale on apples.~~ What error is the shopper most likely making?

Target word: attribution error **Decides:** She explains his behavior by character and ignores his situation.

A	Correct	Overweighting disposition and underweighting situation in judging others.
B	Camouflage	The sale is irrelevant, and no prior belief is being confirmed.
C	Confusion set	Self-serving bias concerns explaining one's own successes and failures.
D	Absolute language	Situations strongly shape behavior.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

When people explain their own late arrival, they tend to cite traffic; when explaining someone else's, they tend to cite laziness. Which pattern is this, and which way does it lean for the self?

Target word: self vs. other attributions **Decides:** Situational for self, dispositional for others.

A	Correct	Actors see their situation; observers see the person.
B	Adjacent category	Reduced effort in groups, not an attribution pattern.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the direction.
D	Confusion set	Concerns group attitudes becoming more extreme.

3. Answer C Concept 2

In a study at a university ~~with a large sports stadium~~, participants complete a boring task. Some are paid \$1 and others \$20 to tell the next participant it was fun. Afterward, all rate how enjoyable the task really was. ~~The study ran in the fall semester.~~ Which group is expected to rate the task as more enjoyable, and why?

Target word: which group changes attitude more **Decides:** Low external justification creates more dissonance.

A	Inverted operation	A large payment justifies the lie, so less attitude change is needed.
B	Absolute language	Dissonance research shows behavior can change attitudes.
C	Correct	Insufficient justification drives attitude change.
D	Dropped element	Drops the difference in justification.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A company wants employees to sincerely value a new safety rule. Which approach does dissonance theory predict will produce the most genuine attitude change?

Target word: design for attitude change **Decides:** Minimal external pressure for the behavior.

A	Adjacent category	Strong threats also provide external justification.
B	Dropped element	Dissonance needs a behavior that conflicts with the old attitude.
C	Inverted operation	Big rewards supply an outside reason, so attitudes need not change.
D	Correct	Weak external justification leads people to explain their behavior by their own attitudes.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A new employee at a law firm ~~with a marble lobby~~ is unsure how to file a complex court form. She watches three coworkers file it a certain way and does the same, believing they know the correct method. ~~The firm has 40 attorneys.~~ What type of influence is this?

Target word: type of social influence **Decides:** She is uncertain and treats others as a source of information.

A	Correct	Conforming because others are seen as correct in an ambiguous situation.
B	Confusion set	Normative is about fitting in, not getting the right answer.
C	Adjacent category	No one gave her a direct command.
D	Absolute language	Much conformity is driven by wanting to be correct.

6. Answer C Concept 4

In a replication of a classic obedience study at a research center ~~with a new parking garage~~, participants are told by an experimenter to deliver what they believe are painful shocks. ~~The study was advertised in a local newspaper.~~ Which change would most likely reduce obedience?

Target word: factor that lowers obedience **Decides:** Situational factors: authority presence, victim proximity, dissenting peers.

A	Absolute language	Ordinary people obey in strong situations; personality screening misses the cause.
B	Inverted operation	A present authority increases obedience.
C	Correct	Dissenting peers sharply reduce obedience.
D	Adjacent category	Added legitimacy tends to increase obedience.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A man collapses on a crowded subway platform during rush hour, ~~next to a colorful mural~~. About 40 people see him fall, but for nearly two minutes no one calls for help. ~~A street musician is playing nearby.~~ What best explains the delay?

Target word: why no one helped **Decides:** Many witnesses spread responsibility.

A	Camouflage	The stem says people saw him fall.
B	Inverted operation	More bystanders usually reduce the chance that any one helps.
C	Correct	The presence of many others lowers each person's sense of responsibility.
D	Absolute language	Helping depends on situational factors, not a fixed trait of city dwellers.

8. Answer B Concept 6

A skilled pianist ~~who teaches at a community music school~~ plays a piece she has performed for years in front of a large audience and plays it better than in practice. ~~The concert hall has red velvet seats.~~ What best explains her improved performance?

Target word: effect of an audience **Decides:** A well-learned task performed in front of others.

A	Confusion set	Loafing is reduced effort when individual work is not identifiable.
B	Correct	An audience boosts performance on familiar, practiced tasks.
C	Inverted operation	For new tasks, an audience impairs performance.
D	Absolute language	For new or complex tasks an audience tends to hurt performance.

9. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A class project is graded only as a group, and one member does very little. What change would most directly reduce this behavior?

Target word: fix for social loafing **Decides:** Make individual contributions identifiable.

A	Inverted operation	Larger groups tend to increase loafing.
B	Correct	Loafing drops when individual effort can be seen and evaluated.
C	Dropped element	Leaves individual effort unmeasured.
D	Adjacent category	An audience relates to social facilitation, not to identifying each person's effort.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A tight-knit hospital leadership team ~~that meets in a sunny conference room~~ approves a costly expansion. Two members privately doubt the plan but stay quiet because the CEO is enthusiastic and they value team harmony. The expansion fails within a year. Which process best describes the decision?

Target word: group decision error **Decides:** Suppressed dissent to preserve harmony.

A	Adjacent category	About reduced effort, not suppressed dissent.
B	Absolute language	Normative pressure contributes to groupthink; it is not unrelated.
C	Confusion set	Polarization is attitudes becoming more extreme after discussion; the key here is self-censorship.
D	Correct	A cohesive group silencing doubts leads to a poor decision.

11. Answer B Concept 8

A volunteer for a nonprofit ~~that runs a community garden~~ asks a neighbor to sign a petition supporting safer crosswalks. A week later she asks the same neighbor to put a large sign on his lawn. He agrees. ~~The neighbor owns a golden retriever.~~ Which technique was used?

Target word: compliance technique **Decides:** Small request first, then a larger one.

A	Inverted operation	Door-in-the-face starts with a large request that is refused.
B	Correct	Agreement to a small request increases compliance with a larger one.
C	Adjacent category	Low-balling adds costs after agreement to the same request.
D	Confusion set	No group norm is described; the sequence of requests is the tactic.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

A fundraiser wants a \$50 donation. Using door-in-the-face, what should she ask first?

Target word: design the first request **Decides:** Start large, expect refusal, then retreat.

A	Inverted operation	That is foot-in-the-door.
B	Dropped element	Skips the initial large request the technique depends on.
C	Adjacent category	That is low-balling.
D	Correct	The concession makes the smaller request feel reasonable.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Fundamental attribution error	Observers overestimate personality and underestimate the situation when explaining others' behavior; the error tends to be weaker in collectivistic cultures.	Explaining a stranger's action by character while ignoring circumstances.	Judging someone from one behavior seen without context.
2	Cognitive dissonance	When actions conflict with attitudes, people feel tension and often change the attitude to fit the behavior—most when the external justification for the behavior was small.	Expecting a bigger reward to produce more attitude change.	A person does something at odds with their belief for little payoff.
3	Normative vs. informational influence	Normative influence is conforming to be liked or accepted; informational influence is conforming because others are seen as a source of correct information, especially when the situation is ambiguous.	Calling all conformity peer pressure.	Is the person unsure of the right answer or afraid of standing out?
4	Situational drivers of obedience	Obedience rises when the authority is present and seen as legitimate and falls when the person harmed is close by or when others refuse.	Assuming only cruel people obey harmful orders.	Changes in who is in the room: the authority, the victim, or a dissenting peer.
5	Bystander effect	The more people witness an emergency, the less likely any one person is to help, due to diffusion of responsibility and pluralistic ignorance.	Believing more witnesses make help more likely.	An emergency in a crowd where no one acts.
6	Social facilitation vs. social loafing	The presence of others improves performance on simple or well-learned tasks and hurts it on complex or new ones (social facilitation); people exert less effort when individual contributions are not identifiable (social loafing).	Thinking an audience always helps or always hurts.	Individual effort that is or is not measured in a group task.
7	Groupthink vs. group polarization	Groupthink is a cohesive group suppressing dissent to reach agreement, leading to poor decisions; group polarization is discussion pushing members' shared leaning to a more extreme position.	Using the two terms interchangeably.	Silenced doubts vs. a stance that grows stronger after discussion.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Foot-in-the-door vs. door-in-the-face	Foot-in-the-door starts with a small request to gain agreement to a larger one; door-in-the-face starts with a large request likely to be refused, then retreats to the smaller target request.	Mixing up which request comes first.	The order and size of the two requests.

Course scope (public description): Social Psychology presents major theories in the field related to how the thoughts, emotions, and behaviors of an individual both influence and are influenced by groups, communities, and society. Topics include the social factors that influence the choices people make, the role cultural expectations play in directing behavior, and how to analyze the roots of your own assumptions. Students will perform self-reflections and analyze case studies of social behaviors. There are no prerequisites for this course.